

its limits is with heavy gaming. Titles like Call of Duty: Mobile or BGMI run well at moderate settings and we got around 58 FPS on average, but extended sessions with graphically demanding games like Genshin Impact cause performance dips after 20–30 minutes. CPU throttling settles at around 88% of peak, which is respectable but not built for intense workload.

This isn't a gaming-first phone, and Tecno doesn't market it as such. What it is, is a smooth and reliable daily driver that feels responsive for the vast majority of users.

The Pova Slim runs on HiOS 15, based on Android 15, and while it offers a wide range of customisation options, the overall experience does feel a bit cluttered. Tecno has packed in a large number of pre-loaded apps, the good news is that most of them can be uninstalled, but the sheer volume is noticeable. You'll also find Tecno's own alternatives to almost every Google app, from Weather to its own version of the Play Store, which can feel redundant at times. On the brighter side, Tecno's in-house AI assistant, Ella, is integrated deeply into the system. It supports 136 languages and can handle a variety of queries, making it a useful addition for users who prefer local language support and voice-based interactions.

BATTERY LIFE

Even with its impossibly thin frame, Tecno has managed to squeeze in a 5160 mAh battery with enough juice to comfortably last a full day and often more, depending on usage.

With mixed use: social media, YouTube, calls, and messaging, the phone makes it to the end of the day with battery to spare. Charging is handled by 45W fast charging, topping the phone up from 0 to 50% in about 25 minutes and to 100% in just over an hour.

What's important is that Tecno hasn't sacrificed endurance for slimmness. The Pova Slim carries itself like a much bulkier phone in terms of battery stamina, and that's a major win.

CAMERAS

The Tecno Pova Slim keeps things simple with a 50MP main camera, a 2MP secondary sensor, and a 13MP front-facing shooter. On paper, it may look modest compared to rivals flaunting triple or quad-camera setups, but it works better than you'd expect at this price point.

In good lighting, it produces vibrant, punchy tones that immediately pop on-screen. Reds and pinks are saturated without clipping, greens are lively, and blues hold their depth well. Multi-coloured scenes, like a set of paper straws, show excellent separation, making photos instantly social-media ready without any editing. Detail retrieval is also respectable, particularly in close-ups of flowers or pollen grains, though



sharpness can vary from shot to shot. Wide scenes usually keep the centre sharp but soften towards the edges, and foliage occasionally takes on a "painterly" effect thanks to noise reduction. Dynamic range, meanwhile, is handled competently. HDR pulls useful detail from both highlights and shadows in difficult scenes, though it can sometimes flatten the overall image.

The portrait mode is a clear highlight with precise edge detection, even around hair strands or glasses, with minimal haloing. The background blur looks natural and skin tones are rendered realistically without the heavy-handed smoothing some phones apply.

The Pova Slim camera is surprisingly capable at close distances, allowing users to capture detailed shots of flowers, textures, or even insects.

The 13MP selfie camera is serviceable but unspectacular. In indoor or

low-light conditions, details soften due to both lighting and processing, though colours and exposure remain usable. It's perfectly fine for video calls and casual selfies but doesn't really set any new standards for sharpness.

The main issues are consistency and processing. Autofocus can occasionally miss, leading to soft shots in otherwise favourable conditions. Noise reduction is also heavy-handed at times, smudging textures when you zoom in. These are familiar trade-offs in this segment, but worth noting if you're particular about sharpness. These cameras are not designed for serious photography enthusiasts, but for casual users who want lively, eye-catching photos in good light, it's a reliable system.

VERDICT

The Tecno Pova Slim is proof that thin phones don't have to be gimmicks. It combines lightweight design, a great display, an enduring battery, and capable cameras into a package that stands out in the crowded Rs 20,000 segment.

It's not for hardcore gamers or night photography, but for those wanting sleek design, solid battery, and everyday usability, it's a strong choice.

In a market where most mid-range phones play it safe, the Pova Slim goes skinny and it pulls it off.

The Tecno Pova Slim is for anyone who misses the comfort of a slim, lightweight design but doesn't want to give up on battery life. It isn't flawless, but it's bold, and that makes it more memorable than most mid-rangers.

–Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 6400 5G+ | RAM: 16 GB (8 GB extended RAM) | Storage: 128/256 GB | Display: 6.78-inch Ultra-bright 3D AMOLED Display | Refresh Rate: 144Hz | Cameras (rear): 50MP + 2MP | Camera (Front): 13MP | Battery: 5160 mAh | Charging: 45W wired | Connectivity: WiFi 2.4+5GHz, Bluetooth 5.4 | Sensors: Infrared, e-compass, proximity sensor

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